

Do you see too little of Windows XP's blue screen of death? Can you get Windows to give you a Blue Screen On Demand?

Send in your solution with the subject "Take a Crack", and your postal address, to takeacrack@thinkdigit.com

Get Windows XP To Give You A Blue Screen On Demand



LAST MONTH'S CHALLENGE

Hike your Vista Experience Rating



Take a Crack and win

Professional Joomla!

by Dan Rahmel

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LAST MONTH'S WINNER

Adarsh Akhilesh Dombivli

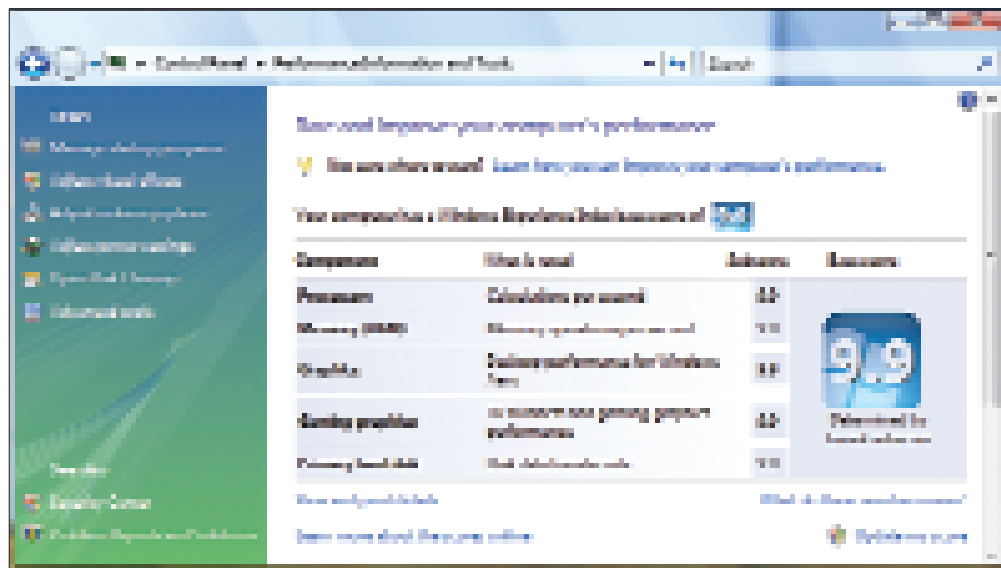
Rules and Regulations

Readers are requested to send in their answers by the 15th of the month of publication.

Employees of Nine Dot Nine Interactive and their relatives are not permitted to participate in this contest.

Readers are encouraged to send their replies by e-mail. Nine Dot Nine Interactive will not entertain any unsolicited communication.

Nine Dot Nine Interactive is not responsible for any damage to your system that may be caused while you are trying to solve the problem.



Vista Experience Rating after the necessary "tweaks"

The Windows Experience Rating is sort of like a system performance gauging system that you only find in Vista. While many complain that it's flawed and unfair at times, there's a way to fool Vista. Basically, we change the performance figures in the XML that holds the scores for each of the subsystems. To see what your system rating is originally, click on Start > Control Panel > System and Maintenance > Performance Information and Tools or if you use the Classic Control Panel, double click on Performance Information and Tools.

1. Open up Windows Explorer and browse to C:\Windows\Performance\WinSAT\DataStore.
2. Right-click on the most recently created XML file there and click on Properties.
3. Click on the Security tab and then on the Edit button.
4. Click on Add and enter the username that you log in using. Click OK.
5. Select the entered ID and check the checkbox for Full Control. Click OK.

6. Click on Yes for any confirmation windows that may pop up. Finally, click OK.

7. Open Wordpad from Start > All Programs > Accessories > Wordpad.

8. Click on File > Open and browse to C:\Windows\Performance\WinSAT\DataStore. Select All files as the type of file using the dropdown menu and select the XML file. Click OK

9. Under the <WinSPR> section, make changes to the scores given. These are the changes we made to strike the totally extraordinary score.

```
<WinSPR>
<SystemScore>9.9</SystemScore>
<MemoryScore>9.9</MemoryScore>
<CpuScore>9.9</CpuScore>
<CPUSubAggScore>9.9</CPUSubAggScore>
<VideoEncodeScore>9.9</VideoEncodeScore>
<GraphicsScore>9.9</GraphicsScore>
<GamingScore>9.9</GamingScore>
<DiskScore>9.9</DiskScore>
</WinSPR>
```

10. Save the file and restart Performance Information and Tools in the Control Panel ■